

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

**School of Business
PMGM7014A China Business Environment
2023-2024, Module 1**

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Dr. Yi Tang
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Phone: 3917-0017
Consultation time: By appointment

TA:
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Class time:
Sep 2, 5, 9, 12, 16, 19, 23, 26, 30; Oct 3, 2024
Mon: 9:30-12:30 pm
Thur: 9:30-12:30 pm

Class venue:
Cyberport Four, 100 Cyberport Rd, Cyberport

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This China Business Environment course examines the challenges and opportunities that a rising and rapidly changing China has provided for various business corporations, i.e. multinational corporations, domestic state-owned enterprises, entrepreneurial firms. It delineates the complexity of contemporary China with respect to economic, technological, political, social and cultural environments and how it influences corporations in a wide range of industries.

Based on in-depth discussions of extensive business cases such as **Google in China**, **WeChat**, **Kuaishou**, **Huawei**, **Haidilao**, **Pinduoduo** and so on, it aims to provide students with analytical frameworks of how managers navigate in the China business environment and address the challenges and threats.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. To provide a detailed understanding of the challenges and opportunities of doing business in China
2. To gain in-depth knowledge of economic, technological, political, social and cultural environments in China
3. To acquire the analytic skills to identify, analyze and resolve management problems across a wide range of industries in China
4. To prepare students for a career in the Great China area

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COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this course, students should be able to:

- Develop analytic skills in analyzing economic, technological, political, social and cultural environments in China **(CLO1)**
- Identify the opportunities and threats faced by foreign and local managers when doing business in China. **(CLO2)**
- Build managerial leadership and competency in solving managerial problems in China Business environment **(CLO3)**
- Develop skills in case analysis, presentation, communication, and team work **(CLO4)**

Programme Learning Outcomes BBA programs

Programme Learning Outcomes	The Course Outcome
<i>PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline</i>	CLO1, CLO2
<i>PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge</i>	CLO2
<i>PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership</i>	CLO3
<i>PLO4: Developing global outlook</i>	CLO1, CLO2
<i>PLO5: Mastering communication skills</i>	CLO4

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities

T&L1. Lectures: Instructors will give lectures on major theoretical frameworks and concepts, and show video clips to help students lay the foundations for the managerial problems at hand.

T&L2. Interactive discussions in class: Students are expected to participate in discussions during the lecturing or during other students' presentation.

T&L3. Group presentations: Students will be asked to form groups and the groups will chose to analyze one business case that interests them most.

T&L4. Self-studies: Students are expected to review the course materials, i.e. hand-outs, business cases before every class. Also they are expected to write an individual paper on selected topics.

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected contact hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Lectures	36	30%
T&L2. Interactive discussions in class	11	9.17%
T&L3. Group presentations	30	25%
T&L4. Self-studies	43	35.83%
Total	120	100%

ASSESSMENT

Assessment Methods (100%)	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
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A1. Class participation: 30%	CLO1, CLO2
A2. Group presentation: 30%	CLO2, CLO3, CLO4
A3. In-class Test: 40%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
Illustrations:	
<u>A1. Class participation: 30%</u> Class participation is essential to the business cases based course, as you will see when you progress to an advance stage of studies, i.e. an MBA program. Although the instructor will lecture on the theoretical frameworks as well as lead the class to analyze several classic business cases, students are expected to answer questions raised during the lecturing. You can either raise your hand to jump into the discussion directly or you will be called randomly by name. Remember there is no right or wrong answers in analyzing the complex business world. So your inputs of alternative views and critical thinking are crucial for the whole class' learning process. More info on class participation? 1) Come to class prepared by reviewing the hand-outs and the assigned business cases of that week. 2) I will mark every time you make a comment, raise a question or participate into the debate, depending on the quality of the content. <u>A2. Group presentation: 30%</u> One of the most important objectives of this course is to develop the students' ability to analyze business cases: the real world examples of business challenges and managerial problems. Students are expected to form groups and each group will select business case that most interest them to do business case presentation. <u>The list of cases can be found in the content of the course below.</u> The faculty will purchase the cases for you and upload them to the class website for students to download. More info on the presentation: a) The group presentations start from Lecture 4. During each of the week, we have one or two groups present. b) The key issues that you can consider in this case study include (but not limit to): what are the external and internal environments the firm in question is facing; how the firm can adopt to and cope with these environments; what the suggestions you can offer to the firm in question for future development and transformation upon facing these environments, etc. c) The presentation is no more than <u>30 mins</u> long, and followed by a <u>10</u> mins Q&A session open to the whole class. d) There is no format requirement for the presentation. The format should be chosen best fitting the context of the case. You can play different roles while making the presentation, i.e. I. <i>Your group is a hired consulting firm to solve the company's problem.</i> II. <i>You are executive members of the company to do job presentation in front of the board.</i> III. <i>You are the government to defend your decision against the entry of the company.</i> What you should do? 1) Form your group no later than <u>September 5th.</u>	

- 2) If you need help for the group presentation, you are welcome to see the instructor during the consultation time.

A3. In-class test: 40%

The end-of-term in-class test will assess your overall understanding of concepts and analytical techniques taught in the course. It is an open-book case analysis. Class content related materials and online information will be allowed in the test. The test time will be about 3 hours.

Please note that there will be NO make-up test!

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-

Consistently exhibits strong analytical skills and the ability to define, analyze and solve managerial challenges and opportunities in the China business environment by applying relevant theoretical frameworks and analyzing them structurally when doing the quiz, presenting the case and writing up the individual paper, consistently demonstrate original thinking, innovative format of presentation and actively and effectively participate in group work and class discussions.

B+, B, B-

Exhibits good analytical skills and the ability to define, analyze and solve managerial challenges and opportunities in the China business environment by applying theoretical frameworks covered in class and analyzing them in some structures when doing the quiz, presenting the case and writing up the individual paper, demonstrate original thinking, innovative format of presentation to a certain degree and actively participate in group work and class discussions.

C+, C, C-

Exhibits some analytical skills and the ability to define, analyze and solve managerial challenges and opportunities in the China business environment by applying some theoretical frameworks and analyzing them in some ways when doing the quiz, presenting the case and writing up the individual paper, acceptable format of presentation and participate in group work and class discussions.

D+, D

Marginally exhibits some analytical skills and the ability to define, analyze and solve managerial challenges and opportunities in the China business environment without applying

theoretical frameworks and without any structures when presenting the case and writing up the individual paper, poor format of presentation and participate in group work and class discussions when urged.

F

Not participate in the presentation, doing poorly in quiz, not hand in individual paper, often being absent from class, arrive late or leave class early without permission.

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Lecture	Date	Module	Note
1	Sep 2	Overview	
2	Sep 5	Political environment	Group sign up & Case selection
3	Sep 9	Economic environment	
4	Sep 12	Socio-Cultural environment	Group 1
5	Sep 16	Technological environment	Group 2
6	Sep 19	Industrial competitive environment 1	Group 3
7	Sep 23	Industrial competitive environment 2	Group 4
8	Sep 26	Business Internal environment 1	Group 5 & 6
9	Sep 30	Business Internal environment 2	Group 7 & 8
10	Oct 3	In-class Test	About 3 hours

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

There are no required textbooks.

- **Required readings:** Slides, cases and other related materials. The course pack will be provided in class.

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

Class Conduct:

- **Attendance:** You are required to attend all classes on time. If you have to miss a class, arrive late or leave early, please write a formal notice to inform the instructor at least one day before the class (i.e. schedule conflict with job interviews). According to FBE policy, students must attend at least 70% of classes in order to pass the course.
- **In class:** Please respect the learning environment of your fellow students. Mute your phones and other electronic devices during class. Talking with classmates is only allowed during the discussion session.

Academic Dishonesty: The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism at <http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/>

Plagiarism, cheating, and other misconducts: Academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated. All materials submitted in this course must be your own original work. Any material not completely original must be credited to the proper source.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Please note that the syllabus and schedule may be changed at the instructor's discretion (i.e. there may be some guest speakers during the semester)

Cases used for group-led class discussion

Environmental analysis: Political

Google and censorship in the Chinese market (1 & 2) (Group 1)

Environmental analysis: Economic

China's state capitalism + China's economy and COVID-19 (Group 2)

Environmental analysis: Social-cultural

Dolce & Gabbana: Racism, stereotypes, or being funny? (Group 3)

Environmental analysis: Technological

Xiaomi's Strategic Leap into the New Energy Vehicle Industry (Group 4)

Industrial competitive analysis: 5-force model

Heytea: From Luxe to Local (Group 5)

The Haidilao Company (Group 6)

Internal analysis of resource and strategy: RBV

Royole: Fall of a Star Unicorn (Group 7)

Pinduoduo (Group 8)